

Free Eats!

The Emergency Food Assistance Program (TEFAP), commonly known as the food stamp program, is a great program to get help with emergency food assistance at no cost. The TEFAP is a federal program that helps supplement the diets of individuals and families. For information you can check out their website at <http://www.fns.usda.gov/fdd/programs/tefap>. Managed by the US Department of Agriculture, the program contact information is: Headquarters Office, Food Distribution Division, FNS, USDA, Room 502, Park Office Center, 3101 Park Center Drive, Alexandria VA 22302. For eligibility details and information on the application process, don't forget to check out <http://www.govbenefits.gov>.

How About Cutting Your Rent?

Is it a constant battle to make payments to your landlord on time? Even if you do make those payments in a timely fashion, you're probably turning over the couch cushions, rounding up whatever you can to pay the rest of your bills. Paying the rent can dry us out, making it difficult to put money into other expenses.

The Section 8 Rental Assistance Program is in place for such situations. Through it, the Public Housing Authority (PHA) steps in and makes payments to your landlord. In doing so, you could end up only paying 30% of your income toward the rent! The unit must adhere to Section 8's quality standards, and households must be low-income to qualify for the program.

The U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development can point you in the right direction. For more information, go to www.hud.gov.

And What if You're Out of Work?

When you're out of a job, it's time to take advantage of unemployment insurance. Every state has it. If, through no fault of your own, you find yourself jobless, you have every right to reap the benefits of free money. Why shouldn't you? We all know how stressful job hunting can be while you're trying desperately to pay the bills. Not a fun scenario. Take that weight off your shoulders and apply with your state. In places like California, you can get up to \$450 a week! That's \$450 every week